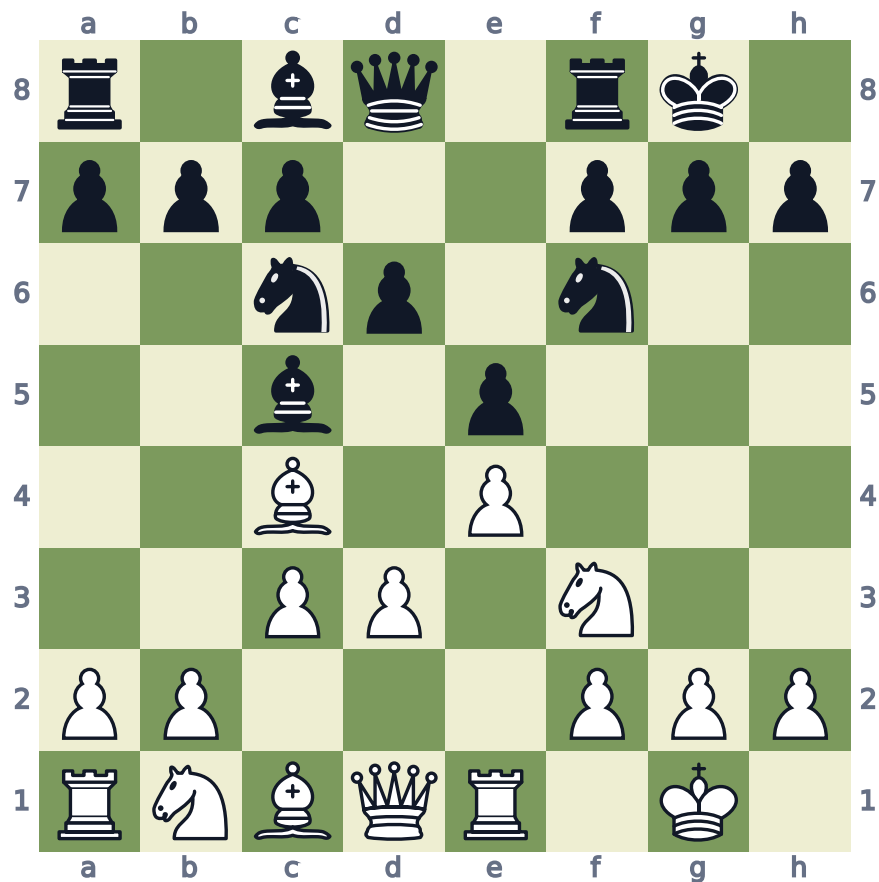


1.e4 Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas

Open centers, Italian tension, Sicilian asymmetry, French chains, Caro space, and Pirc centers



Connect opening moves to the pawn structures, breaks, files, outposts, and piece routes that determine the middlegame.

30 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Connect opening moves to the pawn structures, breaks, files, outposts, and piece routes that determine the middlegame.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 30 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Open centers reward development and king safety.

PRINCIPLE 2

Closed chains point toward the wing where space exists.

PRINCIPLE 3

Asymmetry creates different plans rather than automatic attacks.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Every pawn break opens lines and abandons squares.

PRINCIPLE 5

The least active piece often reveals the next useful move.

PRINCIPLE 6

Structure knowledge converts memorized moves into reusable plans.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRUCTURE CHECKLIST

Read the pawns before choosing a plan

1. CENTER

Is it open, closed, fixed, mobile, or under immediate tension?

2. PAWN BREAKS

Which pawn move can change the structure, and what squares will it abandon?

3. FILES

Which files will open after the likely exchanges?

4. OUTPOSTS

Which squares cannot be challenged by an enemy pawn?

5. BAD PIECE

Which piece has the fewest useful squares, and what pawn move would improve it?

6. WING

Which side of the board does the pawn chain point toward?

STRUCTURE 01 OF 30

Quiet Italian core



WHITE'S PLAN

Prepare d4 while keeping e4 protected and the king safe.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Slow preparation must still answer ...d5 or ...Bg4.

ENGINE SAMPLE

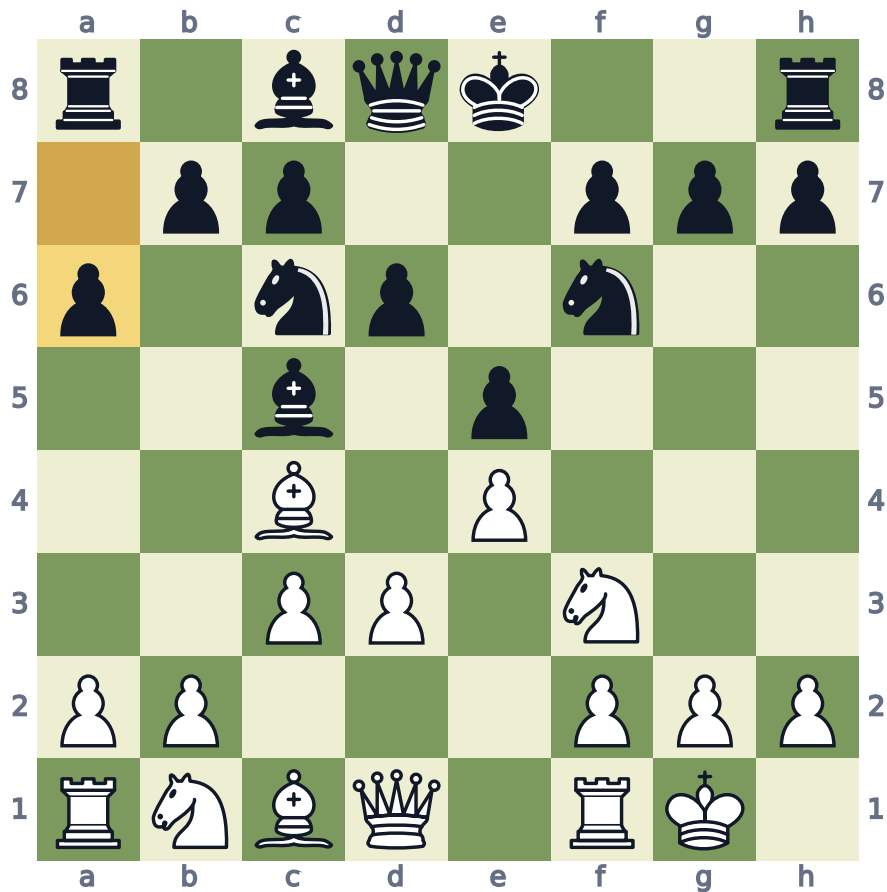
1. a5 Nbd2 2. Be6 Bb5 3. Ne7 d4 4. Ba7 Nf1 5. Ng6 (+0.27 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

d3-c3-Re1 is the quiet Italian engine behind d4.

STRUCTURE 02 OF 30

Two Knights with d3

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Reach the same quiet setup while denying early tactics on e4.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black may use ...O-O and ...d5 if White wastes time.

ENGINE SAMPLE

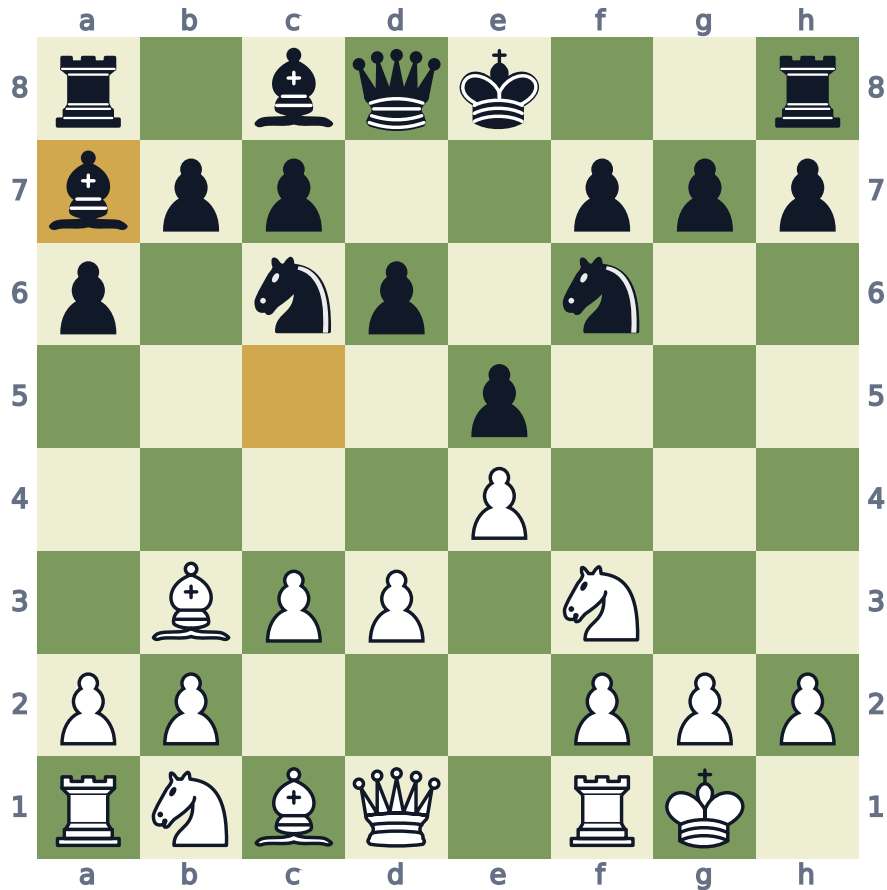
1. a4 O-O 2. Nbd2 a5 3. h3 Be6 4. Re1 Bxc4 5. Nxc4 h6 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Against 3...Nf6, 4.d3 keeps the repertoire coherent.

STRUCTURE 03 OF 30

Italian ...a6 and ...Ba7

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Preserve the bishop and prepare d4 without allowing ...Na5 with tempo.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Automatic retreat can lose time if the center demands action.

ENGINE SAMPLE

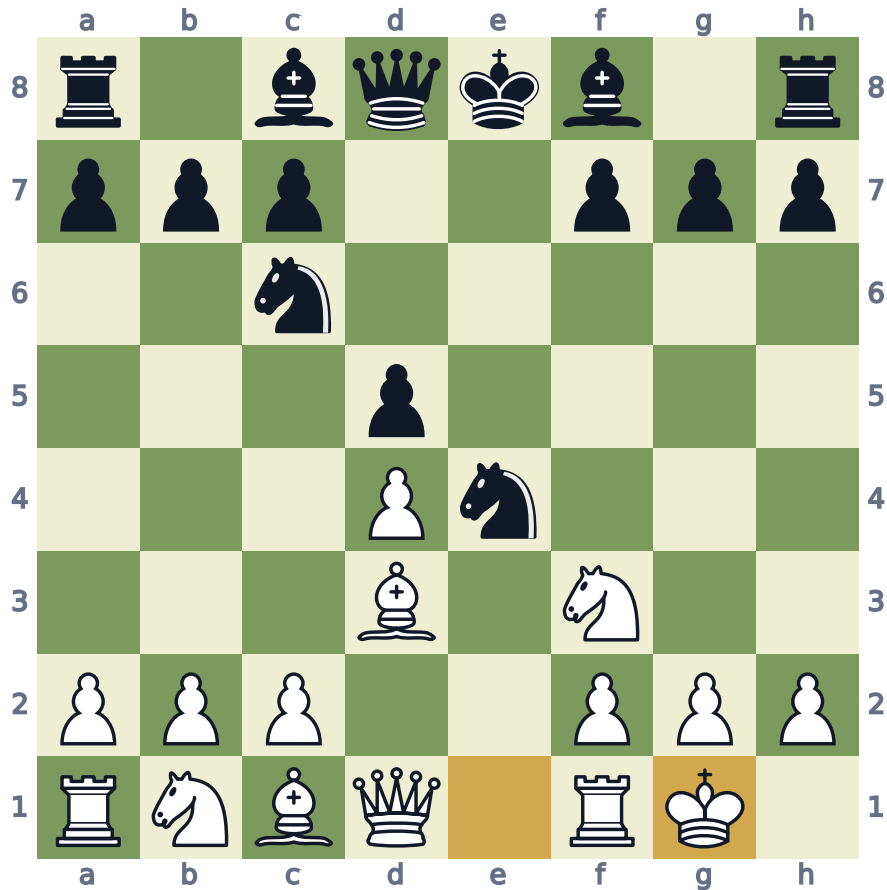
1. Nbd2 O-O 2. Re1 Ne7 3. d4 Ng6 (+0.32 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...a6 often prepares ...Ba7 and ...b5; decide whether the bishop belongs on b3.

STRUCTURE 04 OF 30

Petroff main line



WHITE'S PLAN

Use central space and active development in a symmetrical structure.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The e-file and e4 knight create tactical details.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Be7 c4 2. Nb4 Re1 3. Nxd3 Qxd3 4. c6 cxd5 5. cxd5 Nc3 (+0.52 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

After the forced exchanges, d4 and Bd3 give White the easier development.

STRUCTURE 05 OF 30

Petroff with 3.d4



WHITE'S PLAN

Use immediate central play to avoid pure symmetry.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The e5 knight can be challenged by ...Nxe5 or ...Bd6.

ENGINE SAMPLE

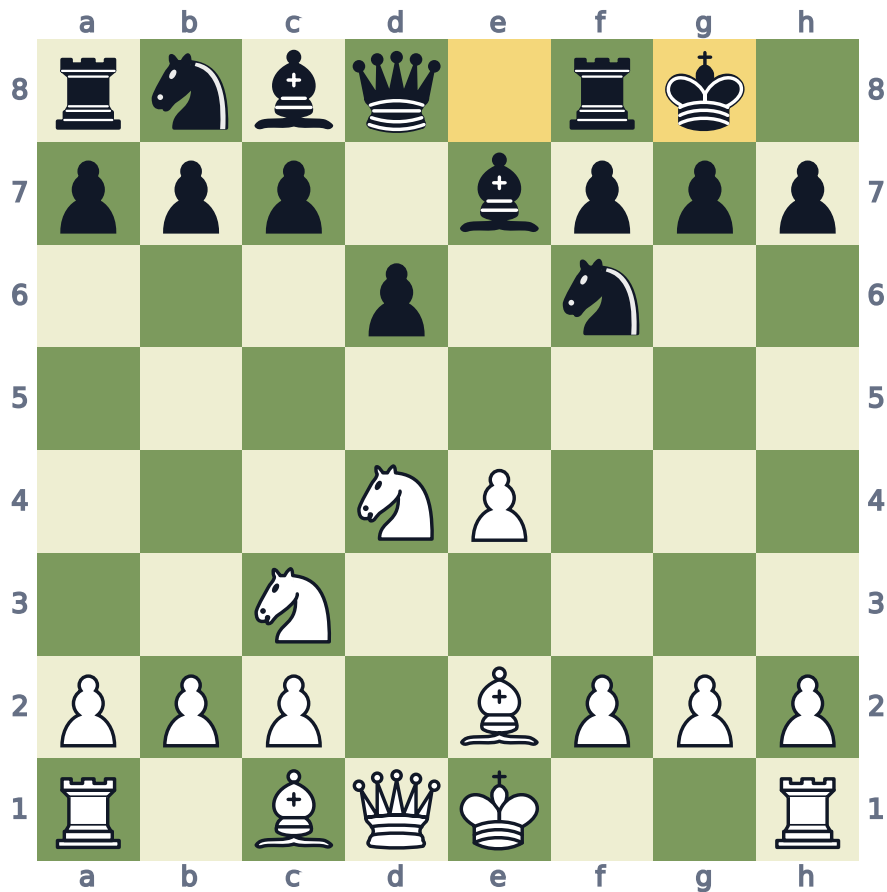
1. Nxd7 Bxd7 2. O-O Be7 3. c4 c6 4. Bxe4 dxe4 5. Nc3 f5 (+0.37 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

3.d4 changes the question from pawn recovery to central activity.

STRUCTURE 06 OF 30

Philidor exchange



WHITE'S PLAN

Use the open center and easier development.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

A careless f4 can expose e4 and the king.

ENGINE SAMPLE

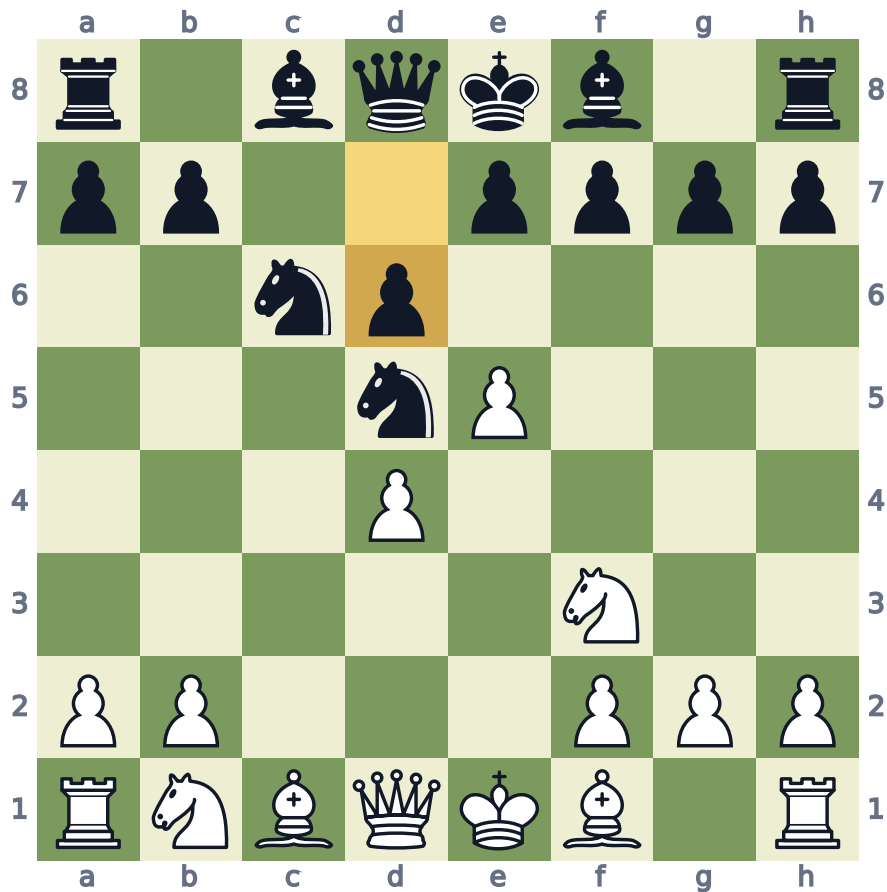
1. Bf4 c6 2. Qd2 b5 3. Bf3 b4 (+0.57 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Exchange on d4 when it opens lines against Black's cramped pieces.

STRUCTURE 07 OF 30

Alapin ...Nf6

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Use space and finish development while the e5 pawn gains time.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black attacks e5 and d4 with pieces and ...d6.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Bc4 dxe5 2. dxe5 Nb6 3. Qxd8+ Nxd8 4. Bb5+ Bd7 5. Nc3 Bxb5 (+0.23 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...Nf6 provokes e5; support the chain rather than overextend it.

STRUCTURE 08 OF 30

Alapin ...d5

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Accept central exchanges and gain development against the queen.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Nc3 can invite a queen capture on d4 if the center is loose.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. cxd4 cxd4 2. Qd8 Nc3 3. Be7 Ne5 4. Nc6 O-O 5. O-O Be3 (+0.25 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

When Black achieves ...d5, develop with tempo and keep a healthy center.

STRUCTURE 09 OF 30

Alapin ...e6

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Build a French-like chain with the c-pawn already supporting d4.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black can attack d4 with ...Qb6 and ...cxd4.

ENGINE SAMPLE

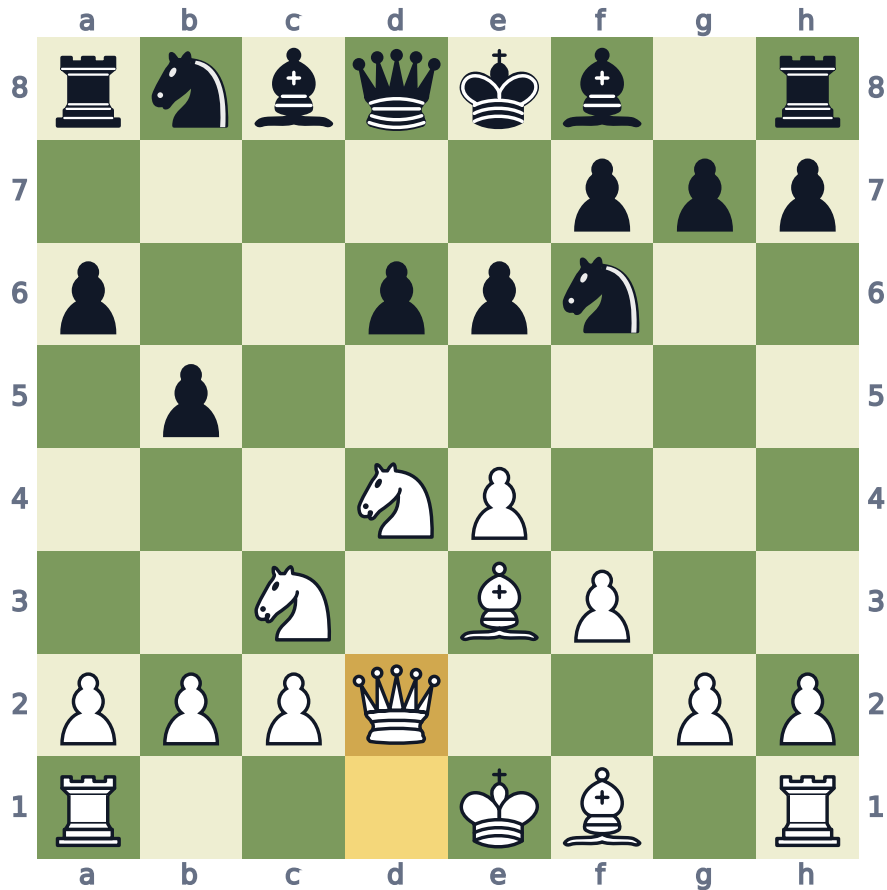
1. Nge7 h4 2. cxd4 cxd4 3. Qb6 Nc3 4. Nf5 Bb5 5. Bd7
(+0.36 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...e6 and ...d5 transpose to a favorable familiar pawn chain.

STRUCTURE 10 OF 30

Najdorf English Attack



WHITE'S PLAN

Prepare long castling and a kingside pawn advance while controlling d5.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black's queenside attack can reach first.

ENGINE SAMPLE

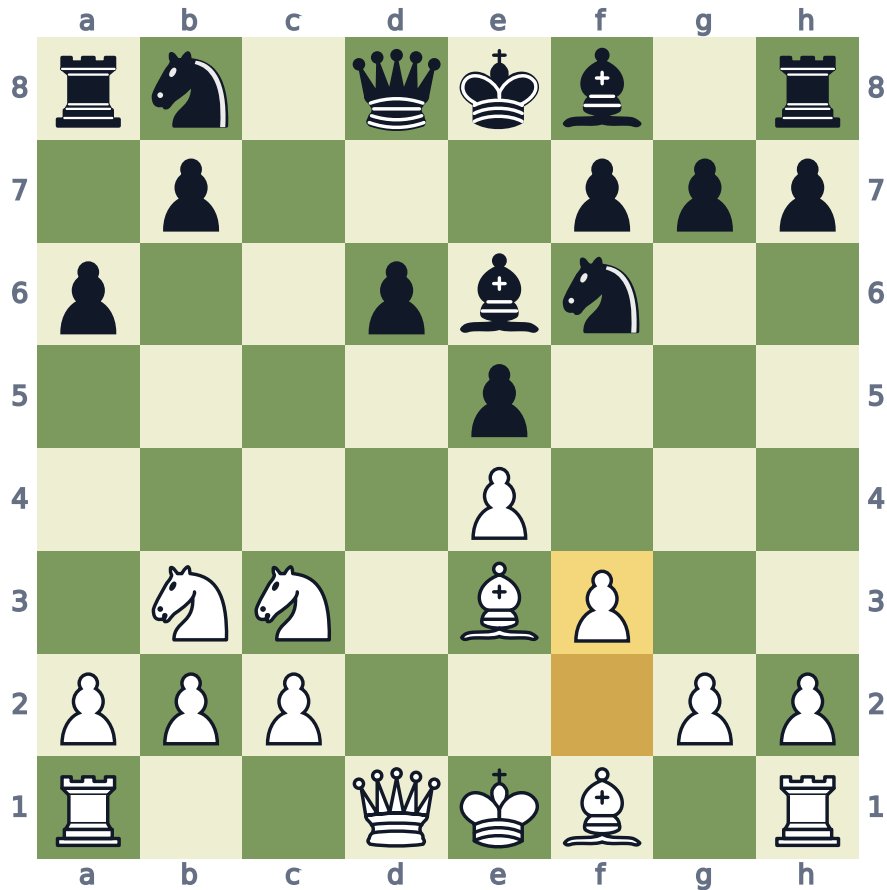
1. b4 Na4 2. Qa5 b3 3. d5 e5 4. Nfd7 f4 5. Nc5 Bd3 (+0.70 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Be3-f3-Qd2 is a coordinated shell, not three automatic moves.

STRUCTURE 11 OF 30

Najdorf ...e5

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Preserve the knight and use d5 as a long-term outpost.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black gains space and can attack d5 with pieces.

ENGINE SAMPLE

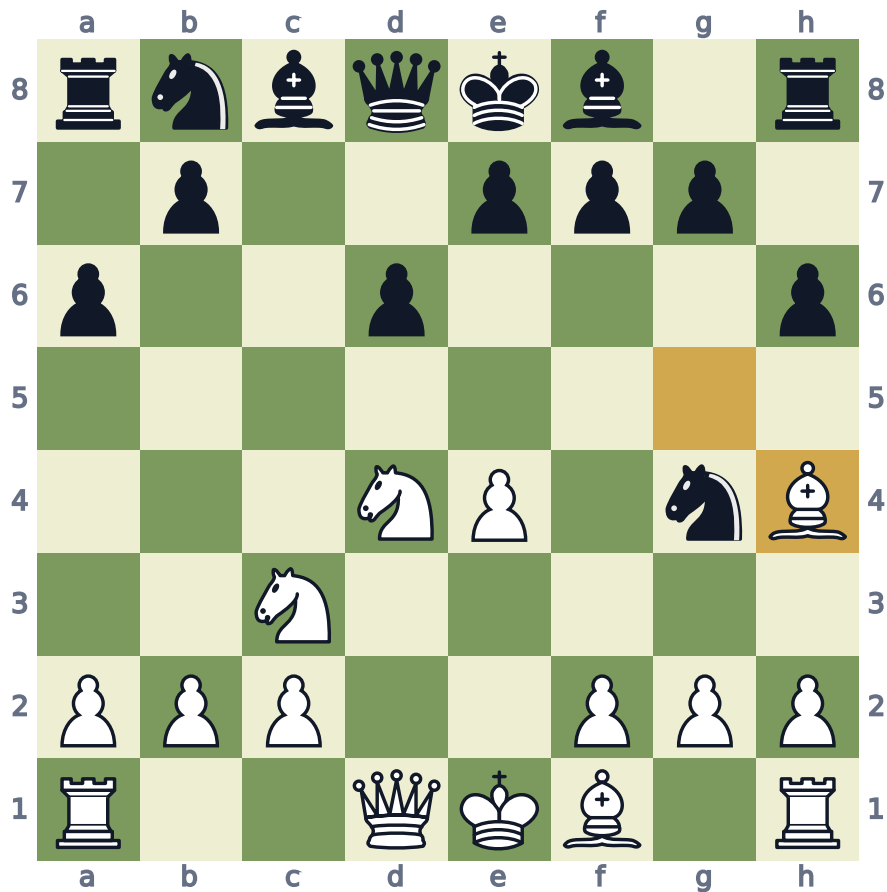
1. Be7 Qd2 2. h5 Nd5 3. Bxd5 exd5 4. Nbd7 c4 (+0.27 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...e5 trades the d5 weakness for time against the knight.

STRUCTURE 12 OF 30

Najdorf ...Ng4

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Keep useful pressure while avoiding an unfavorable bishop trade.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The bishop can lose tempi and become trapped.

ENGINE SAMPLE

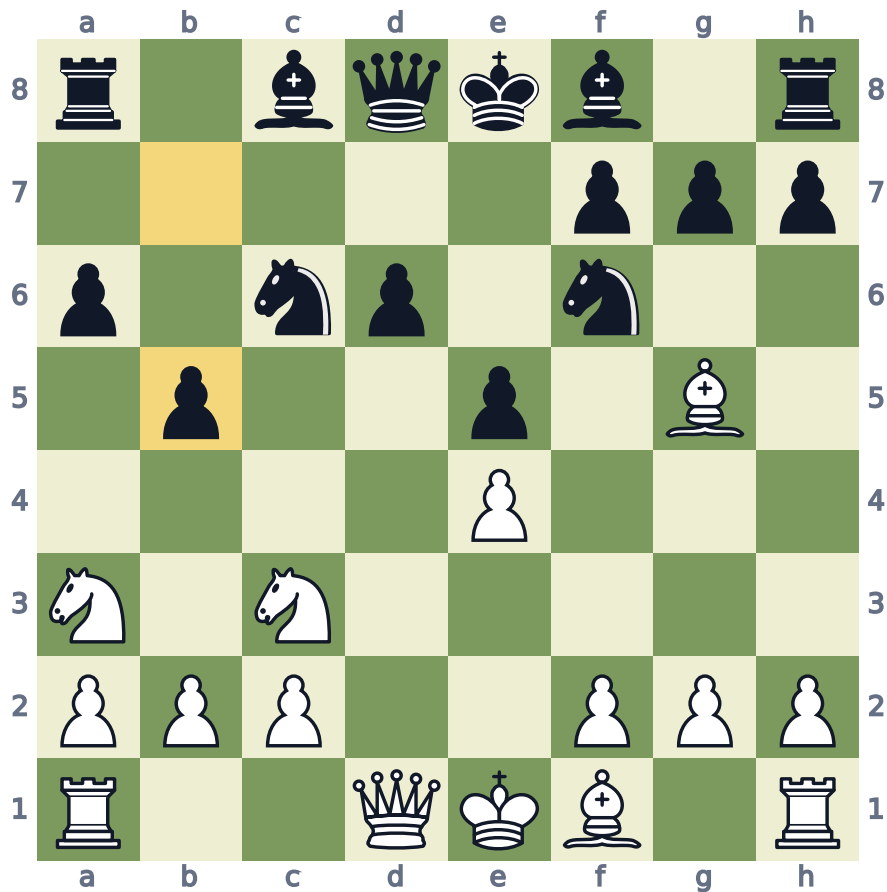
1. g5 Bg3 2. Bg7 Qd2 3. Nc6 Nb3 4. Be6 O-O-O 5. Nge5 h4 (+0.49 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

When ...Ng4 attacks Be3, compare Bg5, Bc1, and exchanges concretely.

STRUCTURE 13 OF 30

Sveshnikov core

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Use the d5 outpost and pressure the weakened dark squares.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black gains activity and queenside space with tempo.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Bxf6 gxf6 2. Nd5 f5 3. Bd3 Be6 4. O-O Bg7 5. c4 fxe4 (+0.48 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...e5 drives the knight but leaves d5 permanently sensitive.

STRUCTURE 14 OF 30

Kalashnikov



WHITE'S PLAN

Use d5 and the lead in development against Black's early ...e5.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The b5 knight can be chased by ...a6.

ENGINE SAMPLE

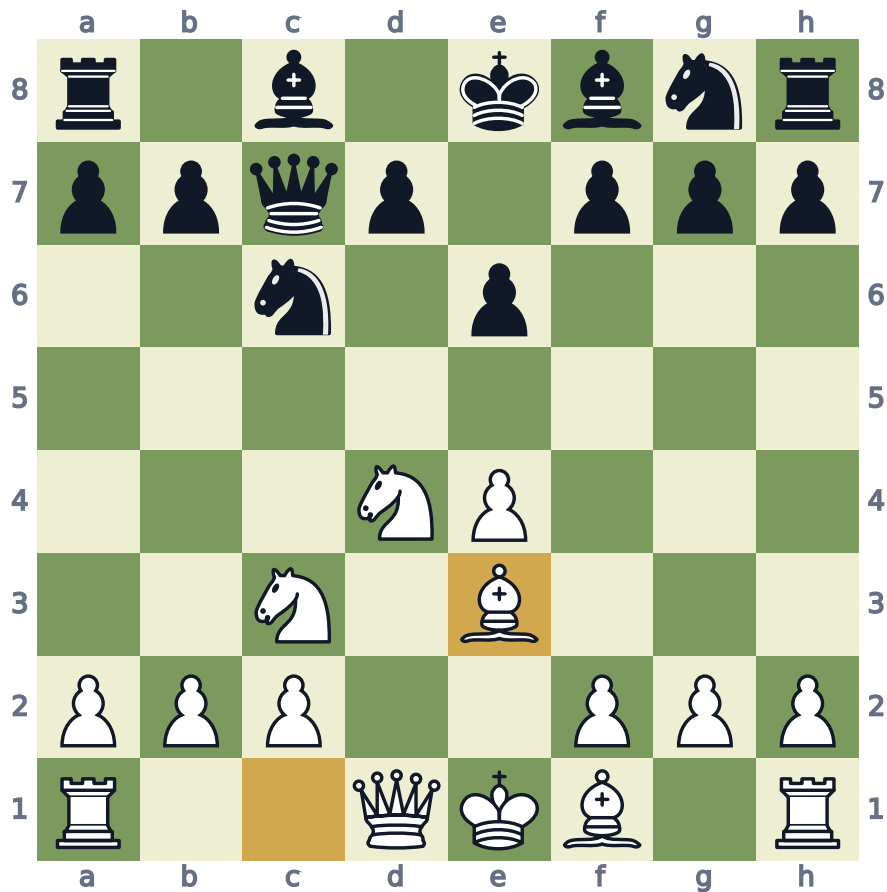
1. Nf6 Bg5 2. a6 Bxf6 3. gxf6 Na3 4. b5 Nd5 5. f5 Bd3 (+0.32 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Without ...Nf6, White can often keep more central flexibility.

STRUCTURE 15 OF 30

Taimanov

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Develop flexibly and prevent ...Nf6 or ...Bb4 tactics from gaining time.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black can strike with ...b5 or ...Nf6 depending on White's setup.

ENGINE SAMPLE

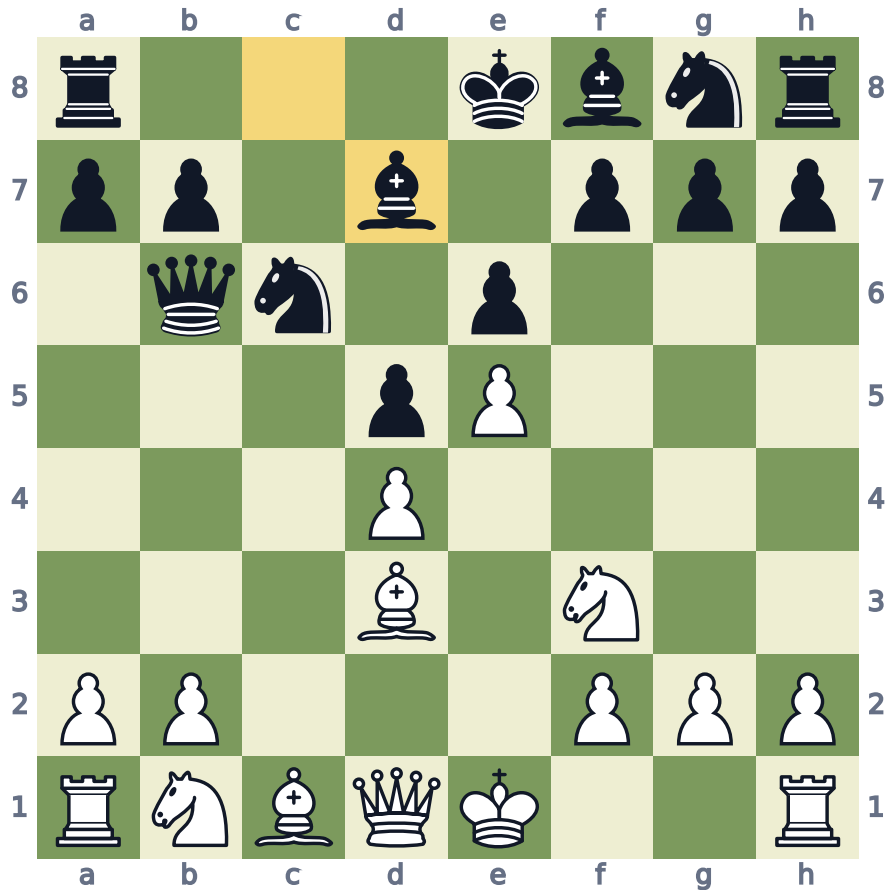
1. a6 Qf3 2. b5 Qg3 3. Qxg3 hxg3 4. Bb7 Nb3 5. Nf6 Nc5 (+0.51 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...e6, ...Nc6, and ...Qc7 identify the Taimanov.

STRUCTURE 16 OF 30

Advance French core



WHITE'S PLAN

Support the center, develop, and prepare kingside play or queenside defense.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

d4 is attacked repeatedly and can collapse tactically.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. O-O Nxd4 2. Nbd2 Nxf3+ 3. Nxf3 a5 4. a3 Bc5 (+0.04 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

Count d4 attackers and defenders before every attacking move.

STRUCTURE 17 OF 30

French ...Nh6

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Develop while Black reroutes the knight toward f5.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Bxh6 can help Black's queen and dark-square attack.

ENGINE SAMPLE

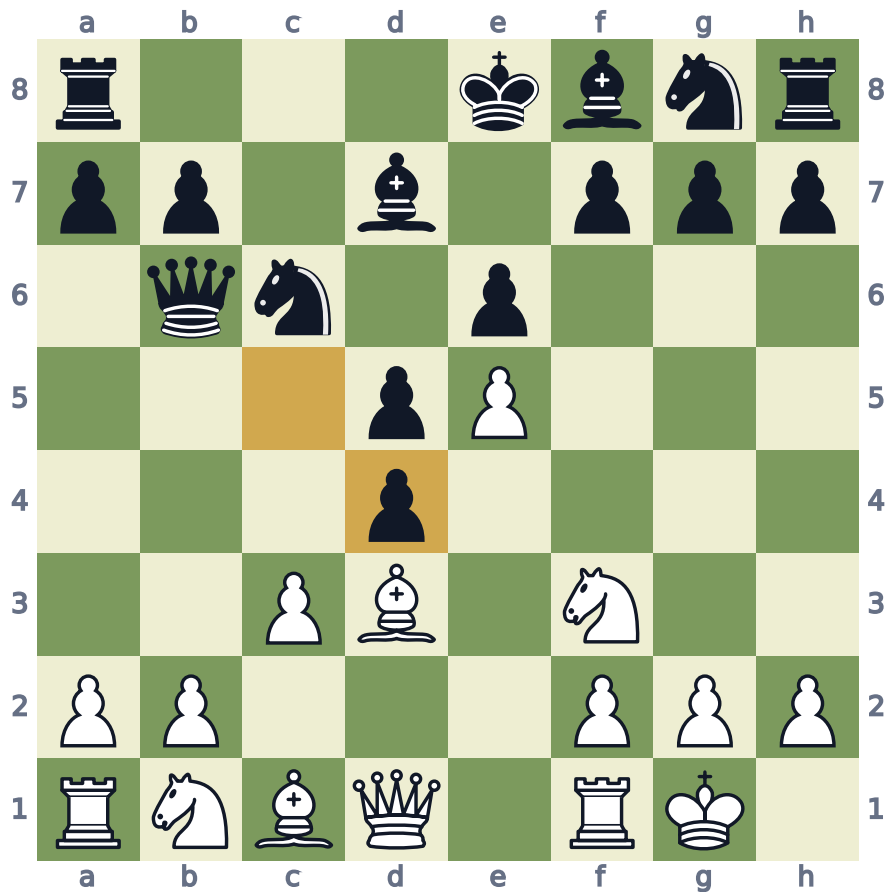
1. Nf5 Bxf5 2. exf5 Nc3 3. h6 Ne2 4. g5 h4 5. Rg8 hxg5 (+0.31 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...Nh6 often targets f5 and d4; do not exchange automatically.

STRUCTURE 18 OF 30

French ...Bd7

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Castle and keep the center supported before choosing a recapture.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The d4 pawn can become isolated after exchanges.

ENGINE SAMPLE

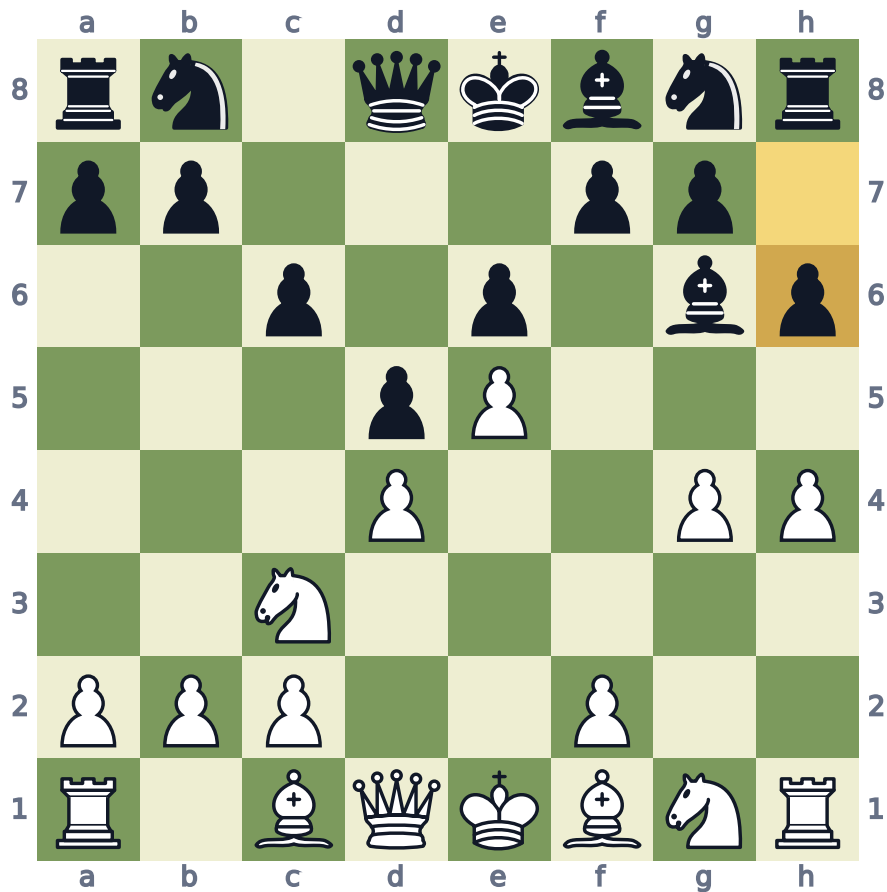
1. a3 Nge7 2. Re1 Ng6 3. h4 Be7 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...Bd7 prepares ...Bb5 or ...Rc8 and completes development.

STRUCTURE 19 OF 30

Advance Caro core

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Gain time against the bishop and use space for a kingside initiative.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Pawn pushes weaken the king and can overextend.

ENGINE SAMPLE

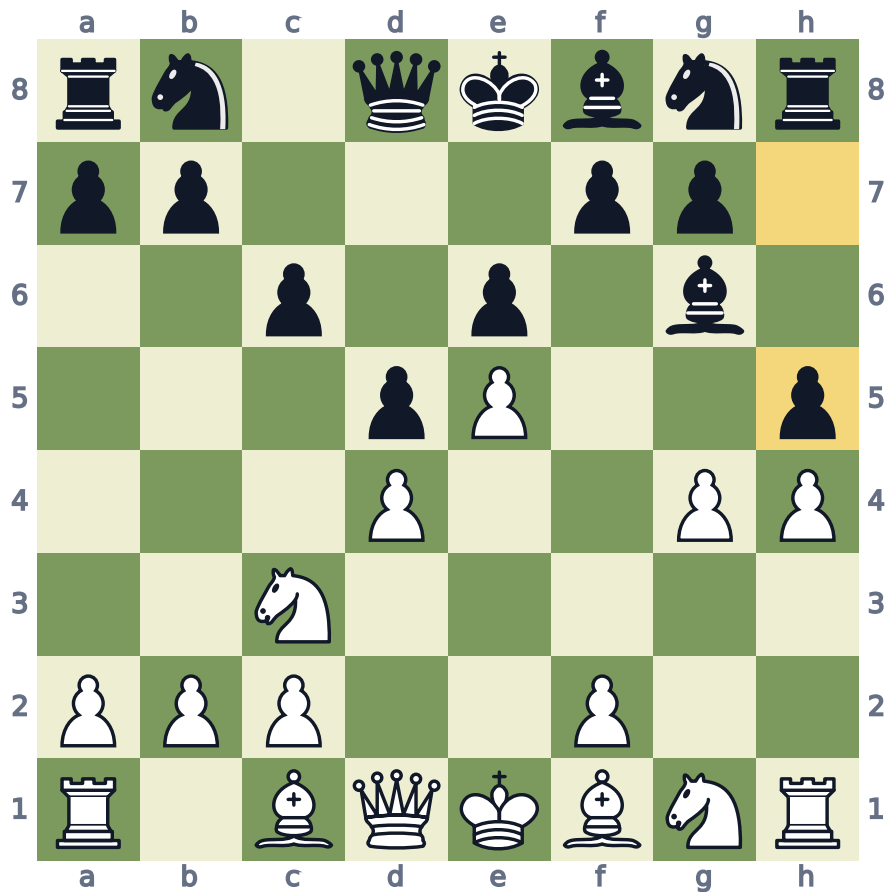
1. h5 Bh7 2. Nf3 c5 3. Be3 c4 4. Bh3 Qb6 5. Rb1 Bb4 (+0.62 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Challenge ...Bf5 only while the center prevents counterplay.

STRUCTURE 20 OF 30

Advance with h5



WHITE'S PLAN

Fix the kingside and decide whether g5 gains space or closes useful lines.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Closing with g5 can give Black f5 and e4 squares.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Bg5 Be7 2. Bxe7 Nxe7 3. gxh5 Bxh5 4. Be2 Bxe2 5. Ncxe2 Nf5 (-0.69 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

When ...h5 stops h5, compare g5 with development.

STRUCTURE 21 OF 30

Short system



WHITE'S PLAN

Develop rapidly and maintain the space advantage without early pawn weaknesses.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black may equalize with ...c5 if White has no active plan.

ENGINE SAMPLE

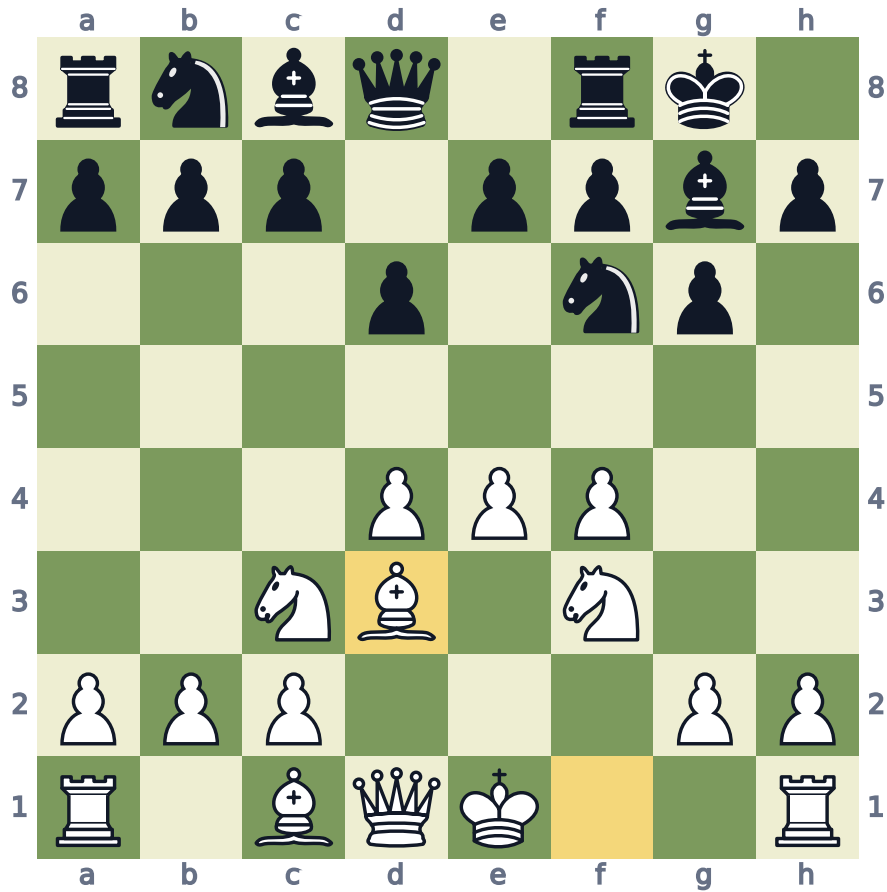
1. c3 cxd4 2. cxd4 Bg4 3. Nc3 Nge7 4. h3 Bxf3 5. Bxf3 Nf5 (+0.27 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Nf3 and Be2 trade some space-gaining tempo for safer development.

STRUCTURE 22 OF 30

Austrian Attack core

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Build the broad center, develop, and prepare e5 or castling.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The center can be struck by ...c5 or ...e5 before White is ready.

ENGINE SAMPLE

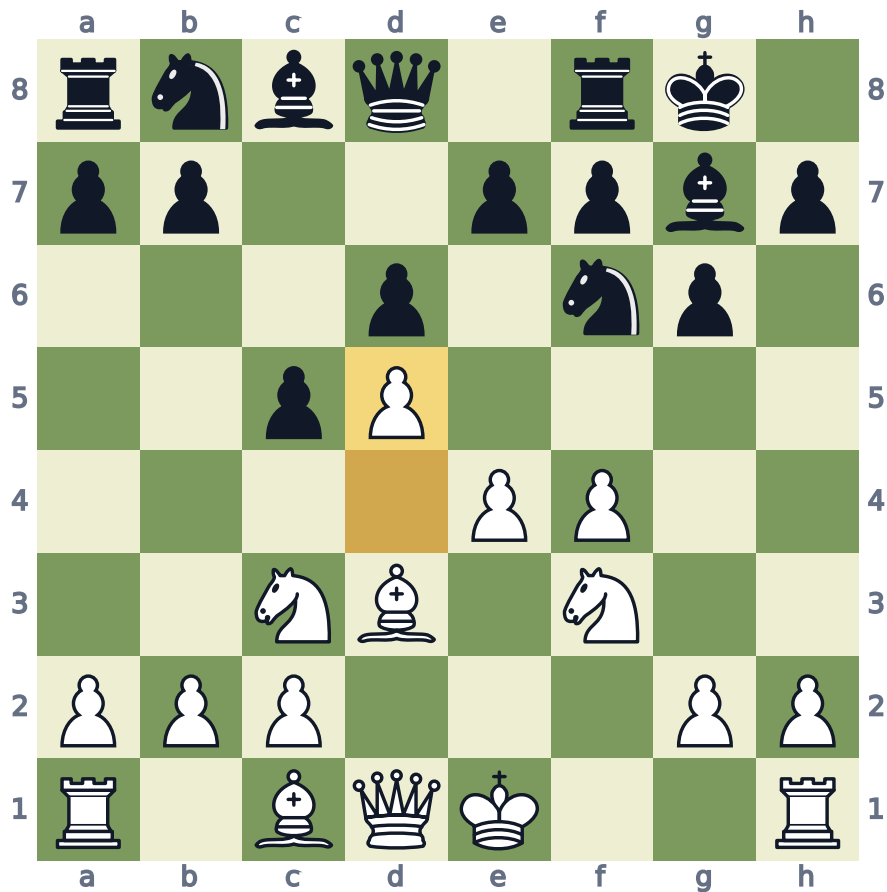
1. Nc6 O-O 2. Bg4 e5 3. Bxf3 Rxf3 4. dxe5 dxe5 5. Nd5 Qe1 (+0.68 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

f4 is useful because pieces are coming quickly behind it.

STRUCTURE 23 OF 30

Pirc ...c5

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Gain space and prepare e5 while Black attacks the center from the flank.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Closing with d5 can give Black b5 and e6 breaks.

ENGINE SAMPLE

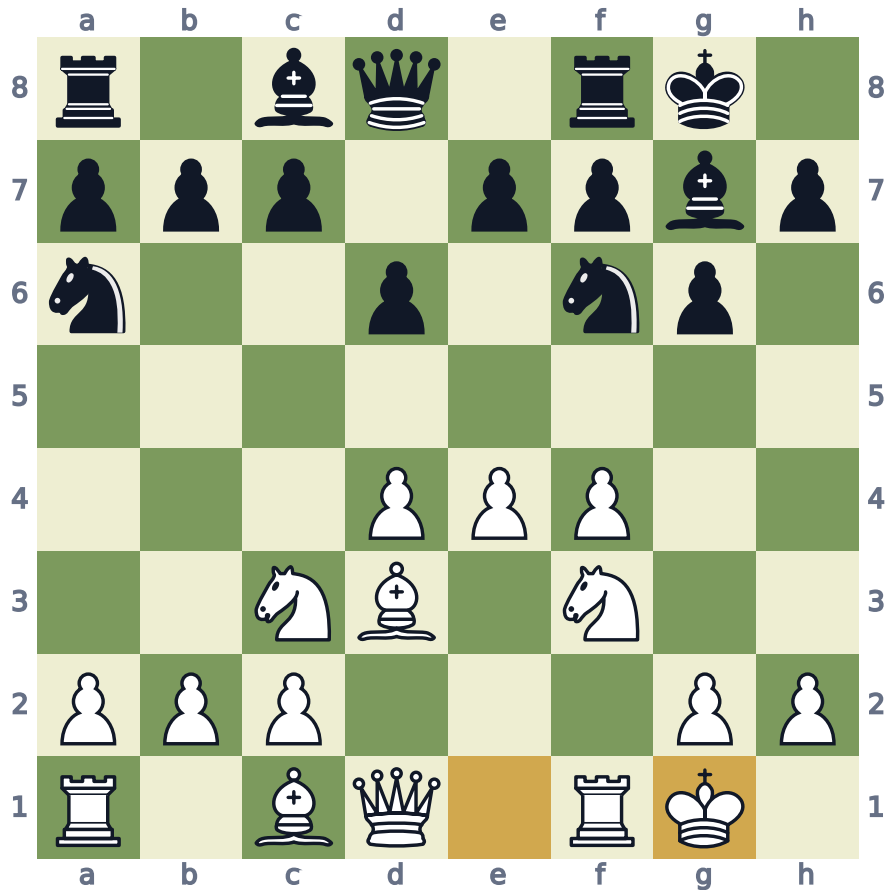
1. c4 Bxc4 2. b5 Nxb5 3. Nxe4 a4 4. a6 Nbd4 5. Nf6 O-O (+0.65 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Against ...c5, choose between d5, dxc5, and e5 by concrete calculation.

STRUCTURE 24 OF 30

Pirc ...Na6

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Castle and keep the center flexible while Black reroutes the knight.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black may play ...c5 and ...Nb4 against Bd3.

ENGINE SAMPLE

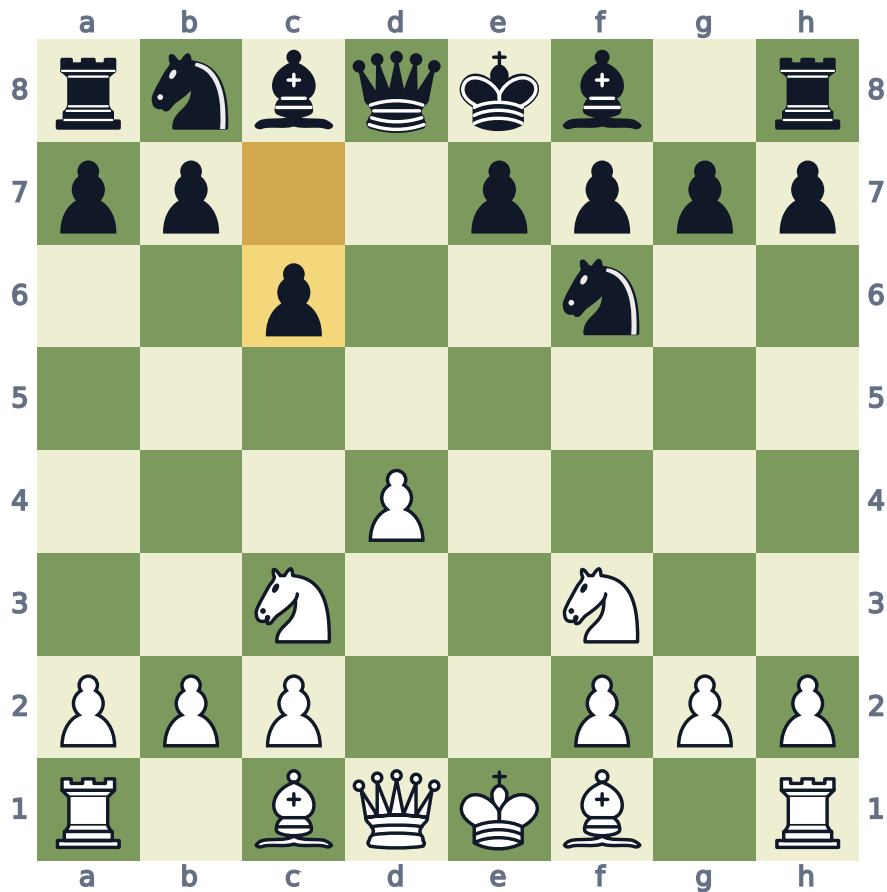
1. Bg4 h3 2. Bxf3 Rxf3 3. Nd7 Be2 4. c5 d5 5. Rc8 (+0.84 for White (White is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...Na6 often supports ...c5 or ...e5 without blocking the c-pawn.

STRUCTURE 25 OF 30

Scandinavian ...Qd8

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Use the development tempo to build a healthy center and castle.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Do not waste the gained tempo on unnecessary pawn moves.

ENGINE SAMPLE

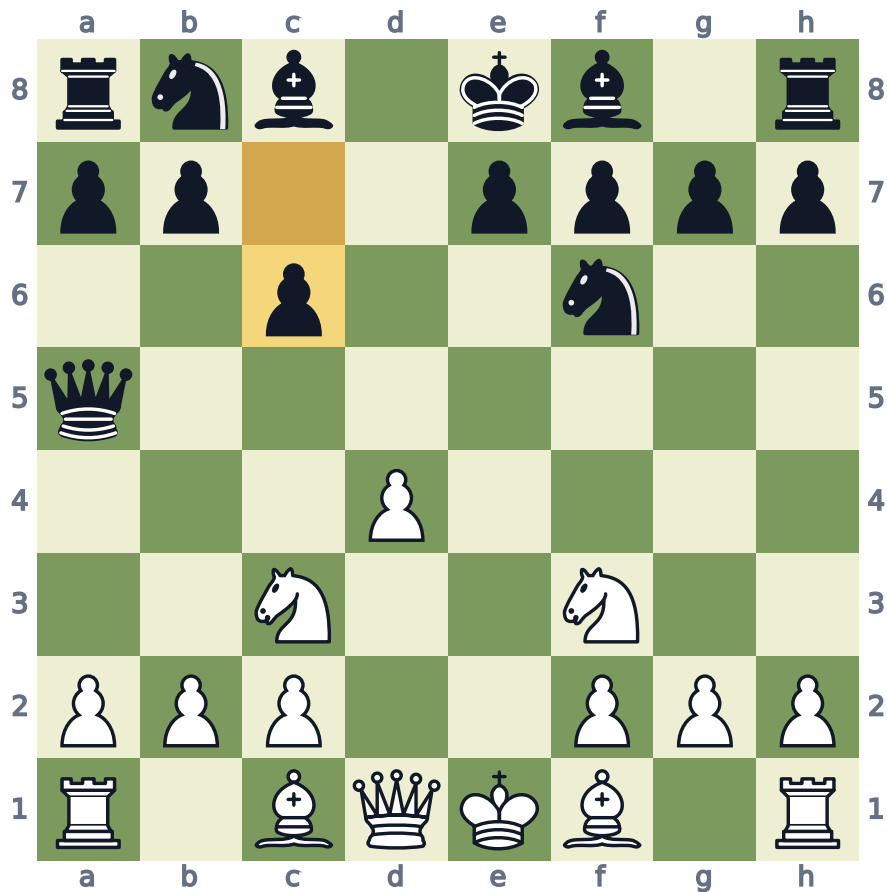
1. Bc4 Nbd7 2. O-O e6 3. Qe2 Be7 4. a4 a5 5. Re1 O-O (+1.01 for White (White is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

After the queen retreats, the advantage is easier development, not material.

STRUCTURE 26 OF 30

Scandinavian ...Qa5

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Develop while watching the pin on c3 and pressure on d4.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The queen can support ...e5 or ...Bf5 with tactical pressure.

ENGINE SAMPLE

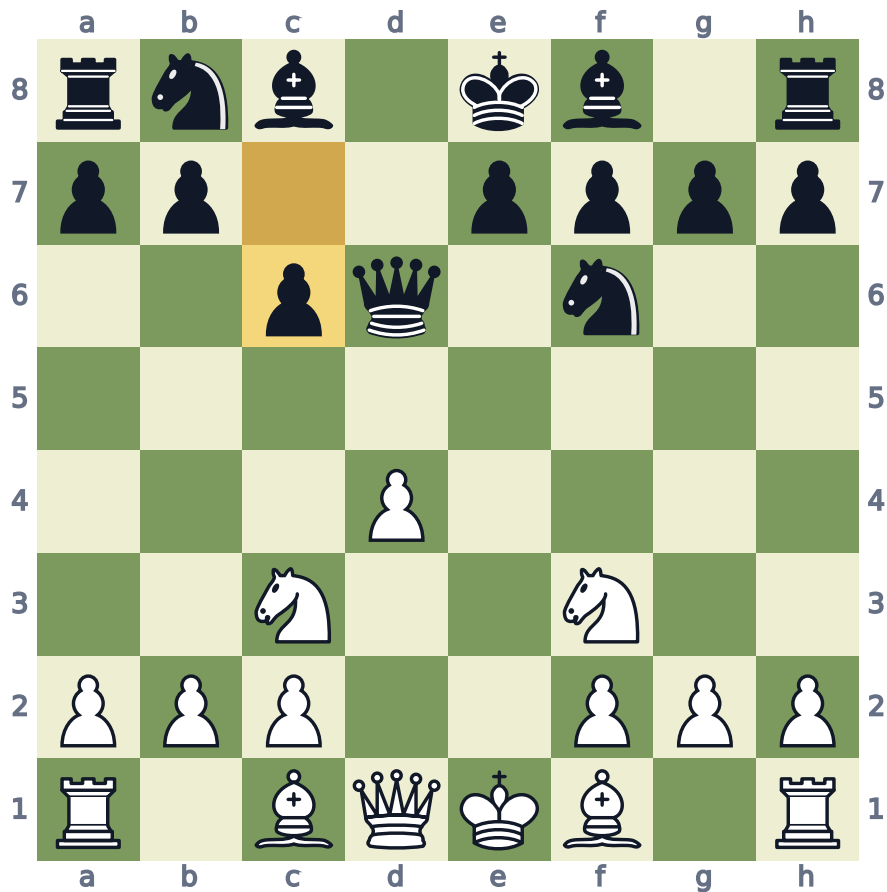
1. Bc4 Bg4 2. h3 Bxf3 3. Qxf3 Nbd7 4. Bd2 Qb6 5. O-O-O Qxd4 (+0.72 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Against ...Qa5, avoid moving the c3 knight before the pin is resolved.

STRUCTURE 27 OF 30

Scandinavian ...Qd6

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Gain space and use natural development against the centralized queen.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The queen may support ...e5 and kingside castling.

ENGINE SAMPLE

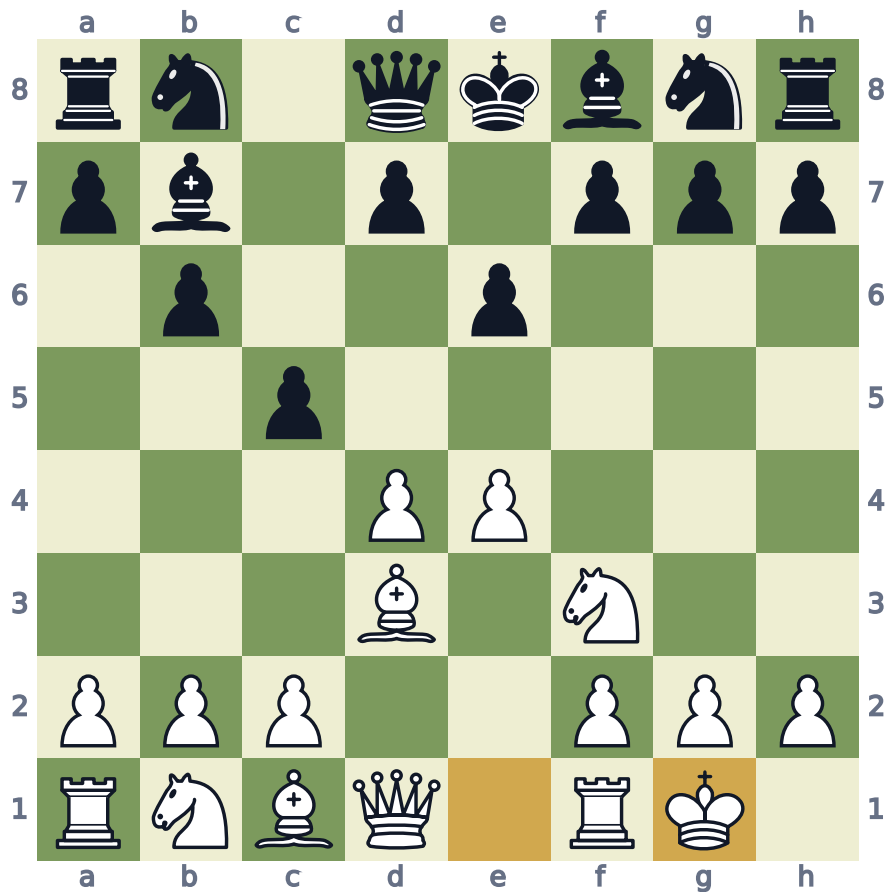
1. Ne5 Be6 2. Be2 g6 3. Bf4 Qd8 4. a4 Bg7 5. a5 (+0.71 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Do not chase ...Qd6 if development gives a larger gain.

STRUCTURE 28 OF 30

Owen's Defense

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Build the center and protect e4 against the long diagonal.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The b7 bishop and ...c5 can attack d4 and e4 together.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. cxd4 Nxd4 2. Nc6 Nxc6 3. Bxc6 Qg4 4. Ne7 Nc3 5. Ng6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

A queenside fianchetto aims at e4; add defenders before expansion.

STRUCTURE 29 OF 30

Nimzowitsch Defense



WHITE'S PLAN

Use development with tempo against the early queen.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The queen can take d4 if White's center is loose.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Bb4 Bd2 2. Bxc3 Bxc3 3. e4 Ne5 4. Nxe5 dxe5 5. Ne7 Qxd5 (+0.31 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

When ...Nc6 and ...d5 attack e4, clarify the center and develop.

STRUCTURE 30 OF 30

St. George Defense



WHITE'S PLAN

Occupy the center and castle while Black spends wing tempi.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The b7 bishop can make e4 tactically sensitive.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. c5 c3 2. Be7 Re1 3. d6 d5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Bxd5 c4 (+1.00 for White (White is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Take the center, then defend it with pieces.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.